

LEADING THE DOGFIGHT

INDIGO

Fleet Size: 277

Aircraft Type: 148 A320 NEO, 27 A320 CEO, 67 A321 NEO, 35 ATRs

Future Deliveries: Up to 350 aircraft

Daily Departures: 1,600

Destinations Served: 74 domestic, 26 International

SPICEJET

Fleet Size: 91

Aircraft Type: B737-700, B737-800, B737-900, B737 MAX, Bombardier 400

Future Deliveries: Orders of up to 205 B737 MAX aircraft, with 13 delivered so far

Daily Departures: 599+[#]

Destinations Served: 51 domestic, 7 international

GO FIRST

Fleet Size: 58

Aircraft Type: 53 A320 NEO, 5 A320 CEO

Future Deliveries: 91 A320 NEO

Daily Departures: 330+

Destinations Served: 29 domestic, 10 international

AKASA AIR

Fleet Size: 6 **Aircraft Type:** B737MAX

Future Deliveries: 18 planes by FY23-end

Daily Departures: 44 **Destinations Served:** 8

3 TATA GROUP CARRIERS

I. AIR INDIA

Fleet Size: 113

Aircraft Type: A319, A320, A321, B777, B787

Future Deliveries: 25 Airbus narrow-bodies and 5 Boeing wide-bodies to be leased in next 15 months

Daily Departures: 360

Destinations Served: 49 domestic, 34 international

II. VISTARA

Fleet Size: 53

Aircraft Type: 41 A320, 5 B737NG, 5 A321 NEO, 2 B787-9

Future Deliveries: 70 aircraft by 2023-end

Daily Departures: 250

Destinations Served: 31 domestic, 11 international

III. AIRASIA INDIA

Fleet Size: 28

Aircraft Type: 5 A320 NEO, 23 A320 CEO

Future Deliveries: Nil

Daily Departures: 196

Destinations Served: 18

[#]SpiceJet is currently operating at 50 per cent of this capacity as per DGCA orders

SOURCE BT RESEARCH

GRAPHICS BY RAHUL SHARMA

maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO) facilities to provide engineering services for aircraft. Even ground handling firms were scarce. "This meant developing one's infrastructure at a huge investment. IndiGo is now largely self-sufficient with its pilot training facility, its MRO hangar almost ready at Bengaluru to perform C-checks, and its well-developed ground handling. It can also use these capacities for servicing other carriers," an industry insider tells *BT*, requesting anonymity. IndiGo also pioneered the sale and leaseback (SLB) model in Indian aviation. Under SLB, an airline buys an aircraft from the manufacturer at an attractive price and sells it to a lessor or lender who then leases

it back to the original owner. "By placing bulk orders and adopting the SLB model, they have been able to get good discounts on equipment and generate liquidity, which is fundamental to the airline business," says Ajay Kumar, Managing Partner at law firm KLA Legal.

Over the years, IndiGo has developed into a veritable ecosystem of aviation-related services. The parent, InterGlobe Enterprises, has seven verticals—the airline, hotels in India, a business unit providing travel bookings and travel agency management solutions, representative services for international airlines, a car rental company and a hotel bookings site, international hotels, and pilot training and aircraft maintenance—